AWS FOR VMWARE

4 Essentials for Modernizing VMware-based Workloads

Lift, Optimize, and Transform with AWS



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Embrace change with confidence. Migrate and modernize with AWS.

Ready or not, many organizations that went all in on on-premises virtualization are asking what's next. Now is the time to make a bold choice for the future of your business. Don't let traditional on-premises infrastructure act as a roadblock and limit your ability to innovate. Embrace change and empower your organization with the benefits of cloud.

Long-term business success requires agility, scalability, and innovation. Organizations that embrace these gain a significant advantage in adaptability, enabling them to capitalize on emerging opportunities to rapidly meet changing customer needs. And the cloud is a proven path to attaining these attributes.

Moving virtualized workloads to the cloud opens up the opportunity to reimagine infrastructure and operations and set up your business for ongoing modernization success. A well-executed cloud migration can help you reduce infrastructure and management costs, empower IT teams with automation and self-service, and accelerate transformation. What's more, today's migration efforts have the potential to shape the way you approach your future IT strategy across people, processes, and technology.

As the longest-standing cloud provider supporting VMware customers at scale, AWS offers proven pathways and resources to help you on your migration and modernization journey. Lay the foundation for long-term success with AWS by reshaping your organization into an agile, cost-efficient powerhouse primed for innovation and growth.

Running VMware-based workloads on AWS offers you the opportunity to:

- Assess and plan for progressive migration and modernization at your pace.
- Leverage purpose-built tooling for lifting and shifting and replatforming virtual machines (VMs) to EC2.
- Explore proven pathways to replatform to containers and serverless architecture.
- Optimize compute and storage resources to reduce total cost of ownership (TCO).
- Embrace DevOps integrations for simpler, automated application infrastructure.
- Reskill teams with specialized training and certification for vSphere admins.
- Drive innovation and transformation with emerging technologies like generative AI.



Asking the right questions

Is it better to fast-track a migration to cloud? Or is it time to plan a more comprehensive cloud strategy for modernization at scale? There is no one right answer, but there is a way to ensure migration success, no matter which path you choose. In this ebook, discover four critical considerations—and the questions you should be asking—on your path to virtualization modernization.

4 key factors for cloud success

A successful cloud migration requires careful consideration of four critical factors. These elements not only streamline the migration process but also lay the foundation for maximizing your cloud benefits. Addressing these factors proactively enables your team to navigate cloud adoption with confidence.

1

Flexible and tailored migration approaches

- What are the needs of my organization, and how can the cloud help me?
- Do I have critical deadlines or timelines for my cloud migration project? How will I ensure they are met?
- Does my cloud provider offer tailored migration approaches and guidance according to my organization's needs?

2

Critical cloud skills and training

- Does my IT team have the necessary skills and expertise to manage and optimize cloud infrastructure and services effectively?
- What training and upskilling programs do I implement to bridge any skill gaps within the organization?

3

Purpose-built migration tools

- What tools and automation solutions will I leverage to streamline and accelerate the migration process?
- How will I ensure compatibility and integration between existing systems and the cloud environment?

4

Cost optimization and migration guidance

- Have I conducted a thorough cost analysis to understand the TCO for my cloud migration?
- What strategies will I employ to take advantage of savings in the cloud?
- Do I have the right people, partners, and support to help navigate and accelerate my transition?

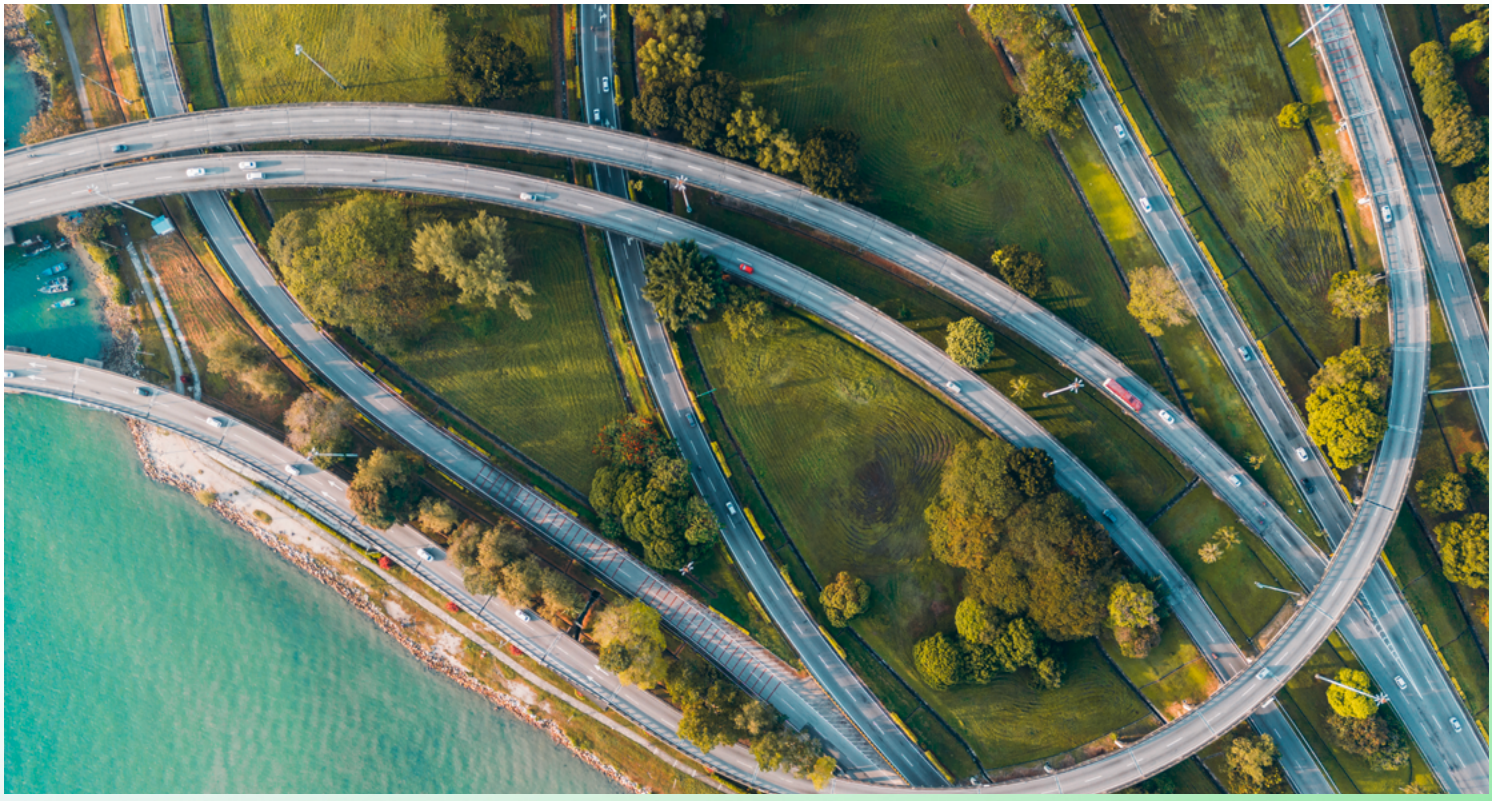
1

Flexible and tailored migration approaches

Migration is never one size fits all.

When you're looking to move to the cloud, it's important to find a partner that can deliver migration approaches tailored to your needs and timeline.

AWS understands that every organization has unique migration timelines and business requirements. That's why we offer a range of migration strategies to accommodate your specific needs, whether you need to meet an immediate deadline or prefer a more gradual approach.



Lift and transform (near-term migration)

For organizations seeking a swift transition to the cloud, this accelerated migration approach is an attractive option. This strategy allows you to quickly lift and shift existing VMware-based workloads to the cloud without extensive upfront planning or discovery processes. With your workloads up and running in the cloud quickly, you can then approach optimization or rearchitecture at your own pace as needed.

This is particularly beneficial for companies facing imminent licensing renewals or expiring contracts with current technology vendors, which can expose you to risk, including vendor lock-in and cost increases.

By embracing a three-step rapid migration approach, you can break free from restrictive solutions and transition workloads to the cloud, mitigating the financial burden of escalating licensing costs. Then, once you're running your workloads in the cloud, further optimization and rearchitecting are often much easier.

Swiftly transition to AWS and adopt cloud-optimized operations



Rapid discovery and planning

- Assess your VMware estate.
- Establish foundation and build a near-term migration plan to help accelerate your migration.

Lift and shift

- Rehost your workloads to AWS EC2.
- Optimize processes, utilize automations, and implement minor reconfigurations.

Modernization at your own pace

- Devise a strategy to replatform or rearchitect them over time, according to your timeline.

Lift and optimize (full migration planning)

For those with complex infrastructure or who are looking to migrate and modernize at scale, a comprehensive migration planning approach can help ensure a smooth and successful transition to the cloud. This approach leverages the AWS Migration Acceleration Framework, which provides a repeatable and best practice–based mechanism derived from thousands of migration and modernization journeys.

The Migration Acceleration Framework is divided into three distinct phases: assess, mobilize, and migrate and modernize. Each phase includes activities that help reduce potential blockers and accelerate the migration process. The assessment phase involves a thorough evaluation of existing IT infrastructure, applications, and workloads, enabling informed decision-making and prioritization.

The mobilize phase establishes the necessary foundations, such as cloud landing zones, governance frameworks, and migration processes. Finally, the migrate and modernize phase involves the actual migration of workloads to the cloud, while also exploring opportunities for modernization and optimization.

Full strategic planning to migrate and modernize



Create a case for change

- Work on prioritizing list of actions.
- Build knowledge and skills on key migration topics prior to commiting to the mobilize phase.

Build readiness through experiences

- Establish foundation and build a migration plan with the methodology, processes, tools, and resources to accelerate your migration to the AWS platform.

Transformation at scale

- Migrate and optimize.
- Complete gap analysis and remedies to ensure continuous service improvement.

2

Critical cloud skills and training

Making a cloud migration successful requires an empowered IT team made up of professionals with deep cloud skills and specialized training. To unlock the full potential of VMware-based workloads in the cloud, it's critical that your teams are equipped for a seamless VMware transition to AWS. To that end, AWS offers training and certification tailored to vSphere admins.

AWS training and certification offerings



Digital training
AWS Skill Builder



Instructor-led classrom training



AWS certification



AWS education programs

AWS training and certification teaches how AWS services can help organizations and IT teams build cloud fluency with modern application development skills and offers certifications to validate expertise. Learners can engage in multiformat training options that include short online videos and digital curriculum, classroom courses delivered by instructors in public classes around the world, and private on-site training suited to individual team needs.

In addition, we've developed the Migration Foundations Readiness Path, a complimentary AWS Skill Builder training tailored for your IT teams migrating to AWS. This on-demand learning path equips your teams with knowledge of AWS migration services and migration strategies, providing a solid foundation for successful cloud migrations.

We also offer classroom instructor-led training with AWS Migration Essentials. This one-day fundamental-level course will help your teams learn how to plan lift-and-shift migrations to AWS as well as the methodologies for discovering, planning, performing, and tracking migrations with various AWS tools and services.

3

Purpose-built migration tools

Unlock digital transformation, business agility, and faster innovation by migrating to AWS. With purpose-built tools and technology for migrating your VMware-based workloads to AWS, you can retire expensive legacy infrastructure and accelerate innovation.

AWS Application Migration Service

AWS Application Migration Service (MGN) is a highly automated lift-and-shift solution that simplifies, expedites, and reduces the cost of migrating VMs to AWS. You can rehost a large number of physical, virtual, or other cloud servers without compatibility issues, performance disruption, or long cutover windows. It further simplifies your migration and reduces costs by allowing you to use the same automated process for a wide range of applications, without changes to the applications, their architecture, or the migrated servers.

How it works: MGN replicates source servers into your AWS account. When you're ready, it automatically converts and launches your servers on AWS so you can quickly benefit from the cost savings, productivity, resilience, and agility of AWS.

Once your applications are running on AWS, you can leverage AWS services and capabilities to replatform or refactor those applications—which makes lift and shift a fast route to modernization.

AWS Migration Hub

AWS Migration Hub is a central service that delivers a guided end-to-end migration and modernization journey through discovery, assessment, planning, and execution. With Migration Hub journeys specifically built for VMware, you get access to the latest guidance and tools from one location to get automated recommendations, a prescriptive plan, and cross-team collaboration and tracking to accelerate your transformation. Simplify rehost, refactor, and replatform of your VMware-based applications today with prescriptive step-by-step templates and a pipeline of tasks to help you move to AWS efficiently.

How it works: A migration journey is a pipeline of migration-related tasks to guide you through the process of assessing and discovering your infrastructure's current state and understanding your current licensing estate. Journeys will also guide you through tasks for creating landing zones with necessary networking, security, and governance controls; migrating your resources to AWS; and modernizing to AWS cloud-native services.

4

Cost optimization and migration acceleration guidance

Migrating and modernizing in the cloud is an attractive option to reduce or even eliminate third party licensing costs and optimize infrastructure to drive down costs and use those savings to fund an accelerated digital transformation project.

AWS understands the need to optimize costs and accelerate your transition, offering a comprehensive suite of programs, tools, and partner resources to help you meet financial goals and streamline your journey to the cloud.

Start with an AWS assessment

Work with AWS and our partner channel to start a no-cost **Optimization and Licensing Assessment** (OLA) that will provide you with optimization and migration recommendations to reduce your costs on compute, storage, and licensing to run and operate your workloads, even providing cost savings before you start to migrate to the cloud.

Speed up your migration and reduce costs

The AWS **Migration Acceleration Program** (MAP) is a comprehensive and proven cloud migration program based upon the experience of AWS migrating thousands of enterprise customers to the cloud. Enterprise migrations can be complex and time-consuming, but MAP can help you accelerate your cloud migration and modernization journey with an outcome-driven methodology.

AWS rapid migration offering for VMware-based workloads

AWS Professional Services has created a rapid migration solution to help customers seamlessly migrate VMware environments (on-premises or on other cloud providers) to AWS. It provides a comprehensive approach that accelerates and de-risks the migration process, addressing common challenges through streamlined templates, automated orchestration capabilities, pre-designed AWS landing zones following best practices, and optional operational support from AWS Managed Services and technical experts.

Lay the foundation for long-term success with AWS

AWS is the world's leading cloud provider and the ideal partner to help your team migrate and modernize. For decades, we've leveraged our deep expertise and comprehensive suite of migration and modernization services, programs, and partners to help VMware customers globally. With AWS, you can rapidly realize the value of the cloud and experience its transformative benefits long term.

The AWS commitment to continuous innovation, advanced technologies, and a scalable, secure, and compliant infrastructure empowers organizations to navigate the ever-changing business landscape with agility and confidence.

AWS sets you up for cloud success



Most secure environment

- **300+** security features
- Supporting **143** security standards and compliance certifications



Most extensive global infrastructure

- **105** Availability Zones in **33** regions



Most functionality

- **200+** cloud-native services



Largest community of customers and partners

- **Millions** of customers, tens of thousands of partners
- **460+** Migration Competency Partners

Why modernize now

Cloud migration is a major step toward business transformation—and choosing the right cloud provider to work with for your long-term migration and modernization goals is crucial. Choosing AWS gives you the scalable and flexible infrastructure to adapt to changing demands, experiment with new products and services, and scale your operations, as well as to leverage new capabilities like AI and machine learning to enable the data-driven decision-making you need to inform future growth and innovation.

Millions of customers—including the fastest-growing startups, largest enterprises, and leading government agencies—are using AWS to lower costs, become more agile, and innovate faster. AWS has significantly more services, and more features within those services, than any other cloud provider, making it faster, easier, and more cost-effective to move your existing applications to the cloud and build nearly anything you can imagine.

Embark on your cloud journey with AWS today and unlock opportunities for business transformation, now and in the future.



Get started today

Request your no-cost **Optimization and Licensing Assessment here**.

Additional resources:

- **Learn more about AWS for VMware**
- **AWS migration resources**

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